Yousif Nazhat

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Education

Rutgers University — New Brunswick, NJ
Major: Computer Science; Minor: Critical Intelligence — *Expected Graduation: May 2027*

- **Relevant Coursework**: Data Structures, Computer Architecture, Discrete Structures, Linear Algebra

Certifications & Honors

Dean's List | **In Progress**: CompTIA Security+, OffSec OSCP+, HTB CPTS, HTB COAE – Expected Dec. 2026

Professional Experience

10a Labs — Remote
AI Red Teamer — *Aug. 2026 – Present*

- Prompted client remediation after **exposing 17 unapproved disclosures** for a **frontier AI lab client** by testing **over-the-wall (need-to-know) and aggregation leakage** through **retrieval connectors** and comparing **direct/shared-access permissions against owner-connector controls**.
- **Exposed distillation-protection and API-integrity gaps** in **pre-release frontier models** by combining **chain-of-thought (CoT) extraction** with signature-test suites covering **signature-validation bypasses** and **signed-reasoning replay**.
- **Developed adversary-emulation test cases** targeting **prompt injection and skill-scanner bypasses** by combining **context switching and context-window overflow** across conversation threads to test system and **developer instruction precedence, tool calling, retrieval, and persistent memory**.
- **Documented harmful-response findings while evaluating 4 models** to support **cyber-misuse prevention** by probing **AI refusals** against **CBRN-related requests** and malicious uses of **return-oriented programming (ROP)**, preserving response transcripts for safety review.
- **Delivered evidence-backed AI safety and content safety assessments** by grading findings against **client safety policies** and **client and in-house harm taxonomies**, documenting **classifier evasion**, refusal behavior, and permission boundaries, and justifying severity with conversation evidence to guide mitigation priorities.

GUILD AI-Native Defense Manufacturing — New York, NY
Offensive Security & AI Engineering Intern | Y Combinator S26 — *Sep. 2026 – May 2027*

- **Protected bid history and prevented invalid cancellations** by implementing **administrator-only controls**, required cancellation reasons, and permanent audit trails; validated the workflow with **simulated quote requests in development**.
- **Improved bid-tracking reliability**, verified by **database tests and mocked-browser tests**, by automatically refreshing edited bids, removing submitted bids from the active queue, and preserving wait times.

Schindler Group — Morristown, NJ
Cloud Infrastructure & Security Intern — *Jun. 2026 – Aug. 2026*

- **Hardened an in-house Azure agent**, restricting **privilege-escalation and unauthorized agent-to-agent access paths**, by **executing prompt-injection tests** and implementing **Entra ID/Azure AI Foundry identity controls**.
- **Secured Azure LLM-integrated production servers** for Group Cyber Security review by **scoping identity/SAS privileges**, patching configurations, and hardening operational workflows.

RU Cybersecurity — New Brunswick, NJ
Team Lead — *Sep. 2025 – Present*

- **Increased project participation 30%** among **50+ members** by leading Red/Blue Team, SIEM, and Linux workshops and **4 simulated cyber-defense exercises** on infrastructure hardening and threat mitigation.

RU Airborne, Avionics & Integration — New Brunswick, NJ
Design Team Lead — *Jan. 2025 – Present*

- **Delivered integrated avionics within 5 weeks** for a UAV **sponsored by NASA and Lockheed Martin** by coordinating Aerodynamics/Manufacturing teams and validating subsystem interfaces.

Leadership & Involvement

Phi Mu Delta | Alumni Relations Chair: **surpassed fundraising targets by 625%** through **32 local sponsors**.
ISC2 New Jersey Chapter | Active Member

CTF Competitions & Competitive Programming

HTB Cyber Apocalypse CTF 2026 – The Salt Crown | *Placed #12 of 12,000+ Teams* — Jul. 2026

- **Reached protected loopback APIs within a 3-minute reset window** by **bypassing an LLM skill scanner**, mutating agent-controlled egress/permission policies, and chaining trusted skills.
- **Exfiltrated a cross-account ledger record with a 2-turn prompt chain** by **poisoning persistent agent memory** and exploiting broken object-level authorization in a model-selected tool call.
- **Reconstructed an AI supply-chain compromise from 6 Base64/XOR fragments** by recovering a deleted skill from Git history and tracing memory poisoning/browser-data beacons without executing malicious JavaScript.

NYC Vision Hack v.2 | *Google x AI Tinkerers NYC; Invited Solo Builder, 50 Builders* — 2026

- **Delivered Haven's live crowd-density demo with a 0–100 score** by combining NYC DOT camera feeds, Roboflow pedestrian/vehicle detection, and a **FastAPI service on Google Cloud Run**.

Projects & Open Source

PenPal – Open-Source Enumeration Engine | *Creator; Python, TypeScript, MCP, GitHub Actions*

- **Delivered repeatable enumeration through 11 tools and 4 validated playbooks**, backed by **99 automated tests**, by publishing **v1.0.1 to PyPI/npm** with scoped CLI/API/MCP access, masked evidence, and CodeQL-backed CI.

PMD Mu Sigma Alumni Platform | *Next.js, TypeScript, Supabase, Stripe, Vercel*

- **Enabled donations and live reporting across 10 pages and 3 server APIs** by integrating Stripe Checkout, **signed/idempotent webhooks for 6 event types**, Supabase persistence, server-side secret isolation, and donor privacy controls.

Technical Skills

Cloud & Identity: Entra ID, Azure AI Foundry, Azure RBAC, SAS Access Scoping, Server Hardening, Zscaler ZIA/ZPA
AI Red Teaming: Prompt Injection, CoT Extraction, Signature-Validation Testing, Signed-Reasoning Replay, Data Poisoning
Offensive Security & Detection: Kerberos/NTLM, Credential Chaining, Lateral Movement, IOC Enrichment/Triage, SIEM/ELK